

NEPAL TOURIST LEGAL & REGULATORY GUIDE

Updated Official Visitor Guidelines & Legal Regulations

Document Reference: Updated Legal Briefing | Applicable Region: Federal Democratic Republic of Nepal | Language: English

Welcome to Nepal! To ensure a safe, legally compliant, and culturally respectful journey, all foreign nationals entering Nepal are subject to local laws, immigration regulations, and environmental mandates.

1. VISA & ENTRY REGULATIONS (IMMIGRATION ACT 1992)

- Passport Validity:** Your passport must be valid for at least **6 months** beyond your intended date of entry.
- Tourist Visa Mandate:** Foreigners entering Nepal on a Tourist Visa strictly **cannot engage in paid employment or business operations** without explicit official approval.
- Visa Overstay Penalties:** Overstaying incurs daily fines and administrative penalty fees under the Immigration Act.

2. TREKKING & TRAVEL REGULATIONS

- Mandatory Trekking Guide Policy:** Foreign solo trekkers in designated mountain regions must hire a licensed Nepalese guide.
- TIMS Card & Permits:** Trekkers must carry a valid TIMS card and national park/conservation area permits.
- Restricted Area Permits:** Travel to border areas (e.g., Upper Mustang, Manaslu) requires specialized permits via authorized agencies.

3. CUSTOMS & CURRENCY REGULATIONS

Item / Commodity	Legal Allowance / Updated Rules
Foreign Currency Declaration	Amounts exceeding \$5,000 USD (or equivalent) MUST be declared upon arrival at customs.
Indian Currency (INR)	Standard Caution: Traditionally, ₹200, ₹500, and ₹2,000 notes were prohibited. While Nepal Rastra Bank has periodically adjusted provisions allowing Nepali/Indian citizens to carry up to ₹25,000 in ₹200/₹500 notes, general international tourists should strictly avoid high-denomination INR notes to prevent customs complications. <i>Note: ₹2,000 notes have been officially withdrawn by the RBI and are invalid.</i>
Precious Metals (Gold & Silver)	Bullion Prohibited: Carrying raw gold or silver bullion (bars, coins, biscuits) as personal baggage without commercial licenses is illegal and leads to immediate seizure. Jewelry Duty-Free Limits: Personal gold jewelry is allowed duty-free up to 50 grams ; personal silver jewelry is permitted duty-free up to 100 grams . Excess undeclared jewelry will be confiscated.
Drones & Aerial Cameras	Drones require prior permits from CAAN, Ministry of Home Affairs, and local authorities. Unpermitted drones will be impounded.

4. CRIMINAL LAW, DRUGS, AND PUBLIC CONDUCT

CRITICAL NOTICE — DRUG LAWS: Nepal enforces a zero-tolerance policy against illegal narcotics under the Narcotic Drugs (Control) Act 1976. Cannabis (marijuana/hashish) is strictly illegal despite historical or cultural associations. Penalties are strictly enforced and scaled based on the substance and quantity—ranging from fines and up to 1 year imprisonment for personal possession of cannabis, up to 20 years (life imprisonment) for large-scale trafficking of hard drugs.

- **Narcotics & Prescription Drugs:** Carrying unauthorized controlled substances or prescription opioids without official medical paperwork is illegal.
- **Cultural & Religious Respect:** Respect sacred sites. Harm to cows is illegal under the Criminal Code.
- **Photography Restrictions:** No photography in army checkpoints, security zones, or inside temple inner sanctums.
- **Antiques & Heritage Artifacts:** Exporting heritage items older than 100 years without Department of Archaeology certification is illegal.
- **Wildlife Protection:** Transport or purchase of wildlife parts is a non-bailable offense under national conservation laws.

5. KEY EMERGENCY CONTACTS IN NEPAL

Service / Agency	Contact / Phone Number
Emergency Police Hotline	100
Tourist Police Hotline	1144 / +977-1-4247041
Nepal Tourism Board (NTB)	+977-1-4256909

Disclaimer: This updated guide provides a summary of statutory provisions, customs policies, and travel regulations in Nepal. Always verify current details with official Nepalese authorities prior to travel.